

▲ By The Way...

The FlashBoot utility included with the Bonus Pack makes this even easier, and allows you to painlessly save the contents of the RAM Disk to 3.5" disk. See the FlashBoot manual.

The RAM Cache keeps the most frequently used information from your disks in memory, so that when you access your disks, a lot of the information the computer needs is already in memory. This can definitely speed your disk access when it works properly. It's usually not a good idea to allocate more than 128K worth of cache, though—larger sizes are self-defeating, since the computer spends more and more time looking to see if the block is in the cache before it looks on the disk. (You might want to try various cache sizes and time the activities you perform most often. If the cache doesn't seem to help much, release the memory.)

The cache doesn't really use the memory it uses. (Say what?) What we mean is, the memory the cache uses is purgable, so if it's needed by another program, the other program will be able to take it. The cache will not cause out-of-memory errors.

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Even if you set the Ram Cache to zero K, the system still maintains a small (16K) cache. According to Apple engineers, this is the smallest setting which provides acceptable performance with 3.5" drives.

SetStart

The SetStart control panel (Figure 9J) determines which program your computer starts up into. The pop-up menu offers: Finder (the default), the current application (open SetStart while you're using application you wish to start up into and choose this option), or another application.

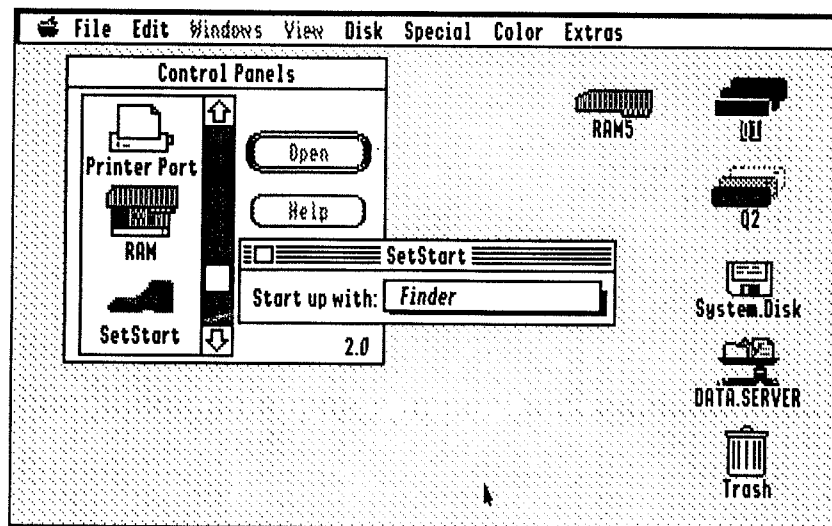


Figure 9J—SetStart Control Panel